



ANCIENT LITERATURE & LITERATEURS — FULL MIND MAP

Topic-wise · Fully Explained · Hinglish · SSC / BPSC / BSSC / Railway



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1. Foreign & Greek Historians

- Greek author Herodotus ko 'Father of History' kaha jaata hai — unki famous book 'Historica' 5th century BC ke Indo-Persian relations describe karti hai. [Q1]
- Pairs check: 'The Natural History' Pliny the Elder (Roman author) ne likhi thi, Ptolemy ne NAHI — Ptolemy 'Geography' likhne ke liye famous hain. [Q84]

2. Grammarians & Linguists

- Match: Ashtadhyayi → Panini; Mahabhashya → Patanjali; Nirukta → Yaska; Varttika → Katyayan. [Q2]
- Match: Panini → Ashtadhyayi; Vatsyayana → Kamasutra; Chanakya → Arthashastra; Kalhana → Rajatarangini. [Q12]
- 'Ashtadhyayi' (Sanskrit grammar ki foundational text) Panini ne likhi thi. [Q15]

3. Vishakhadatta — Mudrarakshasa

- 'Mudrarakshasa' (Sanskrit drama) Vishakhadatta ne likha tha — likha toh Gupta period mein gaya, lekin isme describe kiya gaya hai ki Chandragupta Maurya ne Kautilya ki madad se Nandas ko kaise overthrow kiya. Ye Mauryas ke time ki socio-economic condition ki bhi tasveer deta hai. [Q3, Q4]

4. Classical Literature of the Gupta Era

- Sanskrit literature Gupta period mein apne peak (apogee) par pahunchi — prose aur poetry dono equally likhi jaati thi. Gupta era ke classic literature examples: Amarakosh (Amar Singh), Kamasutra (Vatsyayana), Meghadutam (Kalidasa), aur Mudrarakshasa (Vishakhadatta). [Q5]

5. Other Medieval Authors — Dandin, Surdas & Tulsidas

- Famous authors aur unki books: Surdas — Sursagar, Sur Saravali, Sahitya-Lahiri; Dandin (Dandi) — Daskumarcharitam; Tulsidas — Ramcharit Manas, Vinaya Patrika, KavitaVali; Kalidasa — Abhigyanashakuntalam, Kumarsambhavam, Malavikagnimitram, Meghadutam. [Q6, Q7]

6. Kalidasa — Life, Works & Court

- 'Kumarasambhava' (epic poem) Kalidasa ne compose ki thi. [Q8]
- ⚠ Exam Trap: Kalidasa ki kai epic Sanskrit mein hain, lekin 'Janaki-haranam' unhone NAHI likhi — ye Kumaradasa ne likhi thi. Isi tarah 'Uttararamacharitam' (Lord Rama ki life par 7-act Sanskrit play) bhi Kalidasa ki nahi, Bhavabhuti ki rachna hai. [Q9, Q10]
- Match: Allauddin Khalji → Amir Khusrau; Chandra Gupta II → Kalidasa (Kumarasambhavam, Raghuvansham, Malavikagnimitram); Samudra Gupta → Harisena; Harshavardhana → Banabhatta. [Q36]
- Statements check: Panini ~7th/6th century BC ke the, Pushyamitra Shunga se bahut pehle (jo Patanjali se associated hain) — galat statement. Amarasimha (lexicographer, Navratna) Chandragupta-II ke darbar mein the, Harshavardhana ke NAHI — galat. Kalidasa, Chandragupta-II ke darbar ke sabse prominent Ratna the — yehi sahi statement hai. [Q47]
- 'Shakuntalam' (Abhigyanashakuntalam) Kalidasa ne likhi — unki 7 genuine works mein Vikramorvashiyam, Malavikagnimitram, Raghuvamsham, Kumarasambhavam bhi shaamil hain. [Q52]
- ⚠ Trap: 'Mrichchhakatikam' Kalidasa ki rachna NAHI hai — ye Sudraka ne likhi thi. Kalidasa ki famous masterpieces mein Meghaduta, Ritusamhara aur Vikramorvashiyam shaamil hain. [Q53]
- Kalidasa ka pehla play 'Malavikagnimitram' hai — 5 acts mein, isme Shunga dynasty ke King Agnimitra (Vidisha) aur exiled servant girl Malavika ki love story hai. [Q54]
- Malavikagnimitram mein Agnimitra, Pushyamitra Shunga (Shunga dynasty ke founder) ke bete hain — unki love story is book mein describe hui hai. [Q55]

7. Natyashastra & Performing Arts

- North Indian classical music ki 'Bible Book' Natyashastra hai — ye performing arts par ek Sanskrit treatise hai, Bharat Muni ko attribute ki jaati hai. [Q11]
- 'Natyashastra' Bharatamuni ne likhi — ye ancient India ka treatise hai jo drama, dance aur music cover karta hai, classical Indian arts ka foundation hai. [Q81]

8. Historical Chronicles — Rajatarangini & Gaudavaho

- 'Rajatarangini' (River of Kings) Kalhana (ek Kashmiri) ne likhi — Kashmir ki history ka account deti hai. [Q13, Q14]
- Rajatarangini jaisa hi ek historical work 'Gaudavaho' hai — Vakpati ne likha, jo Kanauj ke raja Yasovarman ke darbar ke poet the. Isme Yasovarman ki digvijaya (conquest) ka detailed description hai (Prakrit epic poem). [Q16]
- Kalhana ke contemporary ruler Jai Singh (1128-1149, Kashmir) the — Kalhana ne Rajatarangini unhi ke reign mein complete ki. Isme 8 Taranga aur 7826 verses hain — pehle 3 Tarangas mein Kashmir ki conventional ancient history hai. [Q37, Q38]
- Kalhana ki Rajatarangini ko Jonaraja aur Srivara ne continue kiya — Jonaraja ne Sultan Zainul Abedin ke reign tak likha (usi naam 'Rajatarangini/Rajavali' se), aur unki mrityu ke baad unke shishya Srivara ne Kashmir ki history aage badhayi. [Q39]

9. Court Poets & Literary Works — Important Match Lists

- Match: Bharavi → Kiratarjuniyam; Harsha → Nagananda; Kalidasa → Malavikagnimitram; Rajasekhara → Karpuramanjari. [Q17]
- Match: Varahamihira → Brihat Samhita; Vishakhadatta → Devi-Chandraguptam (aur Mudrarakshasa); Sudraka → Mrichchha-Katikam; Bilhana → Vikramankadevacharita. ('Prabandha Chintamani' Merutungacharya ne likhi thi.) [Q48]
- Pairs check: 'Devichandragupta' Vishakhadatta ne likhi (Bilhana ne nahi) — galat. 'Hammira Mahakavya' Nayachandra Suri ne likhi — sahi. 'Milinda-panha' Nagasena ka dialogue tha (Nagarjuna ka nahi) — galat. 'Nitivakyamrita' Jain monk Somadeva Suri ne likhi — sahi. Isliye sirf 2 pairs sahi hain. [Q49]
- Match: Ashtanga Samgraha (Vagbhata) → Medical; Das Rupaka (Dhananjaya) → Play/Dramaturgy; Lilavati (Bhaskaracharya) → Maths; Mahabhasya (Patanjali) → Grammar. [Q61]
- Match: Sarvavarma → Katantra; Sudraka → Mrichchhakatikam; Vigyaneshwara → Mitakshara; Kalhana → Rajtarangini. [Q67]

10. Sanskrit Epics Based on the Mahabharata

- 'Kiratarjuniyam' (Sanskrit ki sabse powerful poem maani jaati hai) Bharavi ne likhi — isme Arjuna aur Lord Shiva (Kirata/mountain-hunter ke roop mein) ke beech Indrakeeladri Hills par combat describe hai. [Q18]
- Mahabharata theme wale Sanskrit works: Naishadhiyacharita (Sriharsha, Nala-Damayanti ki story), Kiratarjuniyam (Bharavi, Arjuna-Shiva combat), Sisupalavadha (Magha, Sisupala ka Krishna ko insult

karna). Dashkumarcharitam (Dandi) 10 princes ki adventures ke baare mein hai, Mahabharata theme se related NAHI. [Q19]

11. Scientist-Scholars — Charaka, Varahamihira & Brahmagupta

- Match: Vishakhadatta → Mudrarakshasa (historical drama); Varahamihira → astronomer (Brihat Jataka, Brihat Samhita, Panch Siddhantika); Charaka → Kanishka ke court physician (Charaka Samhita — medicine); Brahmagupta → Indian mathematician. [Q20]
- Match: Charaka → Medicine (1st-2nd century CE ke physician); Brahmagupta → Mathematics (Gupta dynasty se); Varahamihira → astrologer/astronomer; Vishakhadatta → Gupta dynasty ke playwright. [Q21]
- 'Charaka Samhita' Ayurveda (ancient Indian medicine) ka comprehensive text hai — Acharya Charaka ne likhi, jinhe 'Father of Indian Medicine' kaha jaata hai. Ye 120 chapters aur 8 sections mein bata hui hai. [Q22, Q23]
- ⚠ Trap: Varahamihira ne 'Amarkosha' NAHI likhi — ye Amarsimha ne likhi thi. Varahamihira ne Panchasiddhantika, Brihat Samhita aur Brihat Jataka likhi. [Q24]
- Varahamihira ki 'Panchasiddhantika' Greek astronomy par based hai. [Q25]
- 'Brihat Samhita' (Varaha Mihira, Gupta period) ek encyclopedic work hai — astronomy, planetary movements, eclipses, rainfall, clouds, architecture, crops, perfumes waghera jaise wide-ranging subjects cover karta hai. [Q44]

12. Political Treatises — Kamandaka's Nitisara

- 'Nitisara' (ek early politics ki book) Kamandaka ne likhi — isse Indian political thought refine hua, aur ye South-Southeast Asia mein bahut influential rachna ban gayi. [Q26]

13. Playwrights & Their Works — Various Authors

- ⚠ Trap: 'Kadambari' Subandhu ne NAHI, Banabhatta ne compose ki thi — ye ek common galat-match hai. [Q27]
- Bhavabhuti (King Yashovarman, Kannauj ke court poet), Hastimalla (Kannada playwright, Hoysala period) aur Kshemeshvara (11th century Kashmiri poet, 'Dasavatar Charita' ke liye jaane jaate) — teeno playwrights the. [Q45]
- ⚠ Trap: 'Buddhacharita' Vasubandhu ne NAHI likhi — ye Ashvaghosha ki rachna hai (Buddha ki life ki poetic narrative). Baaki sahi hain: Sudraka ne Mrichchhakatikam, Vishakhadatta ne Mudrarakshasa, aur Banabhatta ne Harshacharita likhi. [Q46]
- ⚠ Trap: 'Karpuramanjari' Harsha ne NAHI likhi — ye Rajshekhara ne likhi thi, jo Gurjara-Pratihara kings ke poet laureate the. [Q51]
- 'Matta Vilasa Prahasana' (A Farce of Drunken Sport) Pallava ruler-scholar Mahendra Varman-I ne likhi — ye chhota Sanskrit play 7th century Kanchipuram ki social-religious life describe karta hai. [Q75]

- 'Lalit Vighararaj' (Lalita Vighararaja Nataka) drama Somadeva ne likhi — wo Chahamana (Chauhan) king Vighararaja IV (Bisaldeo, Shakambhari) ke court poet the. [Q76]

14. Milindapanha

- 'Milindapanha' ek Buddhist Pali text hai — Indian monk Nagasena aur Indo-Greek king Milinda (Menander) ke beech ek dialogue ke roop mein likhi gayi hai. Isme agricultural work ke 8 alag phases bhi explain kiye gaye hain. [Q28, Q29, Q30, Q31, Q32, Q33]

15. Regional Bardic Literature — The Raso Texts

- ⚠️ Trap: Raso texts ka sahi pairing: Prithviraj Raso → Chand Bardai; Bisaldeva Raso → Narapati; Khuman Raso → Dalpati Vijay (Karnidan NAHI); Shatrusal Raso → Dungar Singh. [Q34]

16. Jain & Buddhist Texts

- Parishishtaparvan (Hemchandra) aur Trishashtilakshana Mahapurana (Chavund Rai/Chamund Rai) — Jain texts hain. Nettipakarana aur Avadanashataka — Buddhist texts hain. [Q35]

17. Ashvaghosha — Saundarananda

- Ashvaghosha (noted poet, Buddhism ke pracharak) ne famous court poem 'Saundarananda Kavya' likhi. [Q40]

18. Harshavardhana — Playwright-King

- Harshavardhana — ek bade conqueror hone ke saath-saath education-learning ke bade patron bhi the. Unhe 'Ratnavali', 'Priyadarshika' aur 'Nagananda' ka author maana jaata hai — Harshacharita unke court poet Banabhatta ne likhi thi, Harsha ne khud NAHI. [Q41, Q42, Q43]

19. Bhasa's Plays

- 'Swapnavasavadatta' (Svapnavasvadattam) Bhasa ne likhi — Vatsa King Udayana aur Avanti princess Vasavadatta ki romance describe karti hai. [Q56]
- 'Madhyama-vyayoga' Bhasa ki rachna hai (Kavyalankara Bhamaha ne, Natyashastra Bharata Muni ne, aur Mahabhashya Patanjali ne likhi). [Q57]

20. Jayadeva — Geet Govind

- 'Geet Govind' (epic poem, Sanskrit mein) Jayadeva ne 12th century mein likhi — Krishna aur Vrindavana ki gopiyo (khaaskar Radha) ke sambandh ko describe karti hai, 12 chapters mein organize hai. [Q58, Q60]
- Jayadeva, Bengal ke Sena dynasty ke King Lakshmana Sen ke darbar ke royal poet the. [Q59]

21. The Bhagavad Gita & the Mahabharata

- 'Karm karo, phal ki chinta mat karo' (Thy right is to work only, but never with its fruits — कर्मण्येवाधिकारस्ते मा फलेषु कदाचन) — ye famous lines Bhagavad Gita mein Lord Krishna ne Arjuna se kahi thi. [Q62]
- 'Jo yaha hai wo kahi aur bhi milega, lekin jo yaha nahi hai wo kahi nahi milega' — ye famous statement Mahabharata epic mein hai. [Q64]

22. Panchatantra

- 'Panchatantra' (Indian animal fables ka collection) 15 Indian aur 40 foreign languages mein translate ho chuki hai — Pandit Vishnu Sharma ko iski compilation ka credit jaata hai. Mughal era mein Abul Fazl ne isse 'Ayar-e-Danish' naam se Persian mein translate kiya. [Q65]
- 'Panchatantra' originally Vishnu Sharma ne likhi thi. [Q66]

23. Dharmashastra & Law Texts

- Match: Devana Bhatta → Smriti Chandrika; Hemadri → Chaturvarga Chintamani; Madhvacharya → Parashar Madhav; Ballal Sena → Daan Sagar. [Q68]
- 'Mitakshara' (Vijnanesvara ne, Yajnavalkya smriti par vivarti likhi) aur 'Dayabhaga' (Jimutavahana ne likhi) — Hindu property law se related treatises hain. Mitakshara mein beto ko pita ke jeete-ji hi property ka right claim karne ka adhikar tha, jabki Dayabhaga mein sirf pita ki mrityu ke baad. Mitakshara family ke male-female dono members ki property se related hai. [Q69]
- 'Manusmriti' (Manav Dharam Shastra) mainly Social System (samajik vyavastha, laws) se related hai — ye 18 major Smritis mein se ek hai, Manu ko iska author/originator maana jaata hai jinhone social-moral codes establish kiye. [Q78]
- Manu ko ancient India ka great law-giver (aur pehla law-giver) maana jaata hai. [Q79, Q80]

24. Mathematics & Astronomy

- Bhaskaracharya (Bhaskara-II, 12th century) Algebra field mein apne contribution ke liye especially jaane jaate hain — unki famous book 'Siddhantasiromani' ke 4 parts hain: Lilavati, Bijaganita (Algebra), Ganitadhyaya aur Goladhyaya. [Q70]
- 'Lilavati' (Mathematics treatise) ke author Bhaskaracharya ek renowned mathematician-astronomer the. [Q71, Q72]

- Aryabhatta ek renowned mathematician-astronomer the — unki major work 'Aryabhatiya' astronomy, spherical trigonometry, arithmetic, algebra aur plane trigonometry cover karti hai. Wo pehle the jinhone bataya ki Prithvi gol (spherical) hai aur apni axis par ghoomti hai — unhe decimal place value system discover karne ka credit bhi jaata hai. [Q73, Q74]
- 'Zero' (0) ka concept aur digit ek anonymous Indian ne 2nd century BC mein discover kiya tha (baad mein Brahmagupta ne ise formally equations mein popularize kiya). Arabs ne India se ye seekha aur Europe tak phailaya — Arabs ne pehli baar 873 AD mein zero use kiya. [Q82, Q83]

25. Parmar Dynasty — Historical Sources

- Parmar Dynasty ki history ke sources hain: Navsahsank Charit (Padmagupta), Prabandha Chintamani (Merutunga), aur Harsola copper plate inscription. Navsahsank Charita mein Mount Abu ko Parmaras ki origin place bataya gaya hai. [Q50]

26. Sangam Literature & Ancient Trade

- Milindapanha aur Jataka Tales mein merchants/guilds/trade routes ka zikr milta hai, lekin classical Sangam Sahitya (literature) mainly love (Akam) aur war (Puram) themes par focus karti hai — isliye Sangam Sahitya ancient trade routes ke baare mein khaamosh (silent) hai. [Q63]

27. Miscellaneous — Puranas & Ancient Music

- Mahanadi river ka ancient naam 'Nilotpala' Vayu Purana mein mila hai — ye river central-eastern India (mainly Chhattisgarh aur Odisha) se hoke behti hai. [Q77]
- Diye gaye options mein sabse purana musical instrument 'Veena' hai — Vedas mein iska baar-baar zikr hai aur Samudragupta ke coins par bhi ye depict hui hai. Sitar, Sarod aur Tabla bahut baad mein, medieval era mein introduce/popular hue. [Q85]